

What They Called Recovery

KDP Phase 2 Style Sheet

Locked copy-edit conventions for the Kindle production master

Status: LOCKED — KDP Phase 2

1. Editorial scope

- British English is the default for narration and UK-set adult dialogue.
- Character voice overrides house vocabulary where it is intentional. In particular, Zoe may naturally use American lexical choices.
- Phase 2 is a copy-edit only: grammar, punctuation, spelling, usage, accidental repetition, malformed sentences, local ambiguity, and consistency. No developmental rewriting or story changes.
- Every wording change must be logged. Formatting-only repairs that restore lost paragraph/data boundaries are also logged.

2. Language and preferred spellings

Rule	Locked convention
British default	colour; behaviour; centre; defence; grey; organise; realise; recognise; analyse; travelling; cancelled; labelled; catalogue
Licence / practise	licence = noun; license = verb only if required by context; practise = verb; practice = noun.
Accepted retained forms	learned is retained consistently; okay is preferred over OK; email and website are closed compounds.
Programme	programme for non-computing/general contexts; technical source text may retain program if explicitly required.
Percentage	percent is the manuscript convention and is retained.

3. Restaurant terminology and character voice

- In local UK restaurant narration and UK-character dialogue, use waiter/waitress where the staff member is identified by gender.
- Use member of staff when the staff member is unidentified and gender is not established.
- Reserve server for a character whose US lexical voice naturally supports it (notably Zoe) or for an establishment that explicitly uses that job title.

- Do not globally replace server in quoted American speech. Zoe’s Chapter 7 line “You didn’t tell the server I was lying.” is intentionally retained.

4. Punctuation and quotation style

Element	Convention
Quotation marks	Curly double quotation marks for ordinary dialogue; curly single quotation marks for quotations inside dialogue. No stray spaces between nested quotation marks.
Em dash	Closed in prose: word—word. Spaced dash separators may remain inside displayed records, labels, notebook entries, or system data.
Ellipsis	Three periods (...) throughout prose and dialogue; do not use the single ellipsis glyph (...).
Oxford comma	Use where it prevents ambiguity or matches the established sentence rhythm; do not impose mechanically.
Fragments	Intentional fragments and clipped dialogue are preserved. Do not “correct” character cadence into formal complete sentences.

5. Hyphenation and compounds

- Hyphenated: multi-storey, lock-up, lay-by, sat-nav, Wi-Fi, pay-as-you-go, check-in, high-visibility, rear-view mirror, adult-child.
- Open: hard drive, write blocker, child lock.
- Noun forms normally open: car park, service area, service station. Attributive forms may be hyphenated where already natural: car-park, service-area, service-station.
- Do not regularise identifiers, source labels, system strings, or case codes merely for typography.

6. Numbers, time, dates, identifiers and records

- Narrative prose generally follows the manuscript’s existing convention: ordinary small numbers may be words; exact times, dates, distances, case identifiers and technical values use numerals where appropriate.
- System records, archive entries, IDs and case codes retain their source form unless an actual error has been established.
- Spoken times and years may remain written out where that reflects how the character says them.
- Do not convert displayed data into prose during copy-edit. Kindle layout treatment belongs to the later formatting phase.

7. Canonical names and recurring terminology

Category	Canonical forms
Primary names	Elias; Zoe Harper; Jackie; Helen; Brian; Mac; Cain; Voss; Vale; Reyes; Samuel Mercer / Sam; Priya Dey; Elaine; Martin
Organisations / places	Westmere; North Vale; Meridian Placement Services
Recurring labels / codes	Reaper; BRG; MPS; AC019; RCP
Technical / evidential terms	write blocker; hard drive; storage device; working copy; archive; recipient profile; safeguarding

8. Dialogue and voice protection

- Contractions, fragments, clipped syntax, repeated words, and colloquial forms are preserved where they belong to character voice.
- Colloquial alright may remain in dialogue; all right remains available in narration or more formal speech.
- Zoe's American vocabulary is not automatically converted to British vocabulary. Context and speaker identity control the choice.
- Do not flatten Elias's terse operational register, Zoe's age/voice, or the documentary/system register into one house voice.

9. Structural and Kindle-source conventions

- Chapter titles remain Heading 1 in the reflowable DOCX.
- Scene breaks remain exactly: * * *
- Notebook entries, archive records, messages and system outputs retain semantic separation from narration. Detailed Kindle styling is deferred to the later formatting phase.
- Where Phase 1 PDF assembly split a sentence across a page boundary or concatenated data with narration, restore the intended paragraph/text boundary without changing story content.
- Do not introduce manual page layout intended to imitate the PDF; the Kindle edition must remain reflowable.

10. Change-control gate

- No plot, chronology, character motivation, revelation order or developmental prose revision is permitted in Phase 2 unless a genuine copy-edit defect cannot be corrected locally.
- Every wording change is recorded in the Phase 2 copy-edit log with chapter, original text, replacement text and reason.
- Phase 2 passes only when the style sheet is internally consistent, the copy-edit log is complete, and no unresolved copy-edit query remains.